

For Sale: A Place in America

The third area of law we recommended was immigration law. Attorneys who specialize in immigration law are likely to benefit from predicted developments in this area. For example, it will become progressively more difficult to immigrate to this country and become a naturalized citizen. At the same time, the demand for American citizenship will increase greatly, especially among affluent foreigners. Consider how millionaire entrepreneurs and advocates of free enterprise living in Taiwan feel about their future. China also wants their capital and country. China wants the Philippines for its oil. Who can guess how the Chinese government will treat the affluent population of a country it acquires? China is a real threat to many affluent people who live within its influence. Many of these people will seek American citizenship. Immigration attorneys will surely benefit from this trend.

"People do not feel safe," said Chris Chiang of the Taiwan-based Pan Pacific Immigration Company. "They want to come to the USA. Billions of dollars have flowed out of Taiwan since mainland China held naval maneuvers off the island's coast.... China considers Taiwan a renegade province" (Darryl Fears, "Taiwanese Talk Deal on Blighted Area," Atlanta Journal-Constitution, April 27, 1996, p. 1).

The fear of affluent Taiwanese business owners is reflected in their movement of money into America. In fact, they recently invested more than \$10 billion in California alone. Now they are considering investing \$50 million in Atlanta (Fears, p. 1). What do they get for investing in this country?

The million-dollar investor program was created by Congress in 1990. It allows foreign nationals to attain permanent U.S. residency if they invest \$1 million in a U.S. business, provided that investment creates ten jobs (John R. Emshwiller, "Fraud Plagues U.S. Programs That Swap Visas for Investments," The Wall Street Journal, April 11, 1996, p. B1).